ST. JOSEPH'S COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING

(An Autonomous Institution) • OMR, Chennai - 119

LAB RECORD

Professional English Lab Integrated

CLASS CODE: EN25C09

STUDENT DETAILS

Student Name: Inba Thamizhan K

Roll No: _____

Date: _____

Subject Name: Professional English Lab Integrated

DEPARTMENT OF HUMANITIES & SCIENCES • AFFILIATED TO ANNA UNIVERSITY • CHENNAI

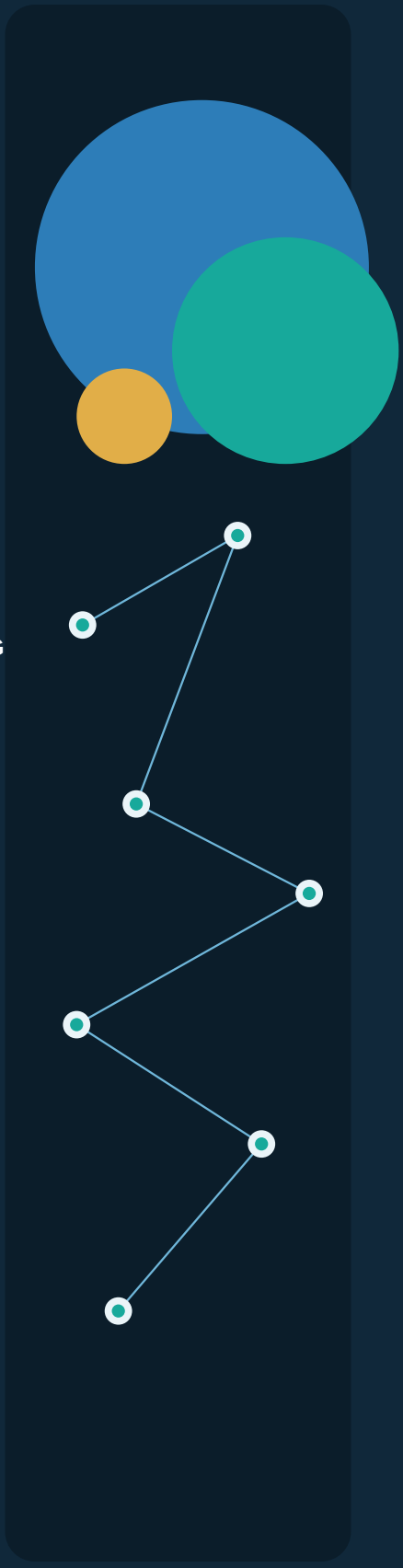
2026

INBATHAMIZHAN K

Computer Science Engineering Student

ASPIRING DATA ENGINEER

Cloud / Data Systems / Software Engineering



BUILDING A FOUNDATION FOR DATA-DRIVEN ENGINEERING

Focused on programming, databases, cloud technologies and practical projects that connect classroom learning with real-world systems.

CAREER DIRECTION

Data Engineering & Cloud Systems

ACADEMIC PROGRAM

B.E. CSE | 2026 - 2030

ENGLISH LEVEL

CEFR C1 - Advanced

St. Joseph's College of Engineering, Chennai

"Learn. Build. Improve. Repeat."

ST. JOSEPH'S COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING, CHENNAI

INBATHAMIZHAN K
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Professional English Lab Integrated | Student edition | 2026

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Editorial note: The original individual profile, project and self-assessment pages are preserved. The common NPTEL lecture notes have been expanded, existing answered worksheets retained with black underlined answers, and personalised applications added. Only repeated lecture summaries and an incorrectly attributed reference score were excluded.

SECTION 01

Profile & Career Direction

Academic foundation, learning style, objectives and long-term vision

I am a first-year Computer Science Engineering student at St. Joseph's College of Engineering. My present focus is on building strong foundations in programming, databases, data structures and software engineering while gradually exploring Data Engineering, cloud computing and DevOps. I prefer learning through practical work because projects help me understand how individual concepts connect to complete systems.

PROFILE

I enjoy learning by building, participating in technical activities and exploring how modern technology can solve practical problems. My interests currently include data systems, real-time applications, maps, automation and developer tools.

CAREER OBJECTIVE

My long-term objective is to develop into a skilled technology professional with a focus on **Data Engineering** and cloud-based systems. I want to move from academic fundamentals to practical engineering experience.

CAREER VISION

First master programming, SQL, databases and problem solving. Then progress into data pipelines, cloud platforms, distributed systems, workflow orchestration and automation.

HOW I WANT TO GROW

Build projects of increasing difficulty, document them on GitHub, use online learning to fill knowledge gaps, participate in hackathons and internships, and create a portfolio that demonstrates what I can actually build.

Education	B.E. Computer Science and Engineering
College	St. Joseph's College of Engineering, OMR, Chennai
Academic term	2026-2030 | First Year
Coursework	SWAYAM: Fundamentals of Computing
Current approach	Coursework + hands-on projects + GitHub learning + technical exploration

A practical learning cycle

LEARN IN SMALL STEPS

Choose one focused topic such as SQL joins, Python functions or data modelling. Use a short explanation and one worked example before moving to practice. Keep the scope narrow, and move on only when I can explain the example in my own words.

PRACTISE AND REVIEW

Attempt a small exercise, check the result and write down what was difficult. Revisit the same idea later so improvement is based on what I can demonstrate. A short note about an error and its correction will also make revision faster.

EVIDENCE I WANT TO KEEP

For each project or course, keep a brief record of the objective, tools used, decisions made, tests performed and next improvement. I will separate what is planned, completed and still in progress so the portfolio stays accurate. For an unfinished feature, I will describe the next test instead of presenting it as complete. This will make my portfolio a record of work rather than only a list of interests.

SECTION 02

Technical Skills & Communication

What I am using now, what I am learning, and how communication supports my growth

Programming	C; Python - developing programming fundamentals, automation and application-development skills.
Databases & Data	SQL; MongoDB; Redis. Learning querying, schema design, document databases and data modelling.
Future exploration	Cloud Computing, Data Engineering, DevOps, pipelines, distributed systems and scalable infrastructure.

CAMBRIDGE INTERCHANGE
Fifth Edition Level 2 | Digital Workbook

150/240	143/150	7/150	97%	3h 1m
Completed	Above target	Below target	Average score	Time spent

CEFR English Proficiency

C1	**ADVANCED** Preply English Test result
4,500	**Words known at this level** 1,250 words remaining to reach the next level
CEFR	At this level, I can use English flexibly and effectively for social, academic and professional purposes. This supports technical presentations, documentation, teamwork and professional communication.

Speak & Improve - Speaking Results

Cambridge Speak & Improve | Complete test practice

Everyday Skills

TEST 1	TEST 2	TEST 3	TEST 4	TEST 5
B1	B1	B2	B1	B1

Advanced Skills

TEST 1	TEST 2	TEST 3
B1	B1	B2

Results show B1 performance in most completed tests, with B2 achieved in Test 3 for both Everyday Skills and Advanced Skills.

SwiftRead | Reading Speed Test

READING SPEED
249 WPM

COMPREHENSION
100%

SwiftRead assessment | Words per minute and questions answered correctly

SECTION 09

The Person Who Inspires Me

Maxime Beauchemin and the kind of Data Engineer I want to become

PERSON

Maxime Beauchemin
Field: Data Engineering & Data Infrastructure

KNOWN FOR

Apache Airflow and Apache Superset
My career goal: pursue Data Engineering

Maxime Beauchemin inspires me because his journey demonstrates how practical engineering problems can lead to tools that are useful to a much wider technical community. The supplied reference material highlights his work on Apache Airflow and Apache Superset and connects that work directly to my interest in data pipelines, automation and data infrastructure.

What I take from his journey is that Data Engineering is not simply database work. It involves designing reliable systems, building pipelines, automating repetitive tasks, solving complex technical problems and making information useful for others. This gives me a clearer picture of the kind of engineer I want to become.

TECHNICAL SKILLS THAT INSPIRE ME

Python, SQL, data pipelines, workflow orchestration, data infrastructure, data visualization, automation and distributed data systems.

PROFESSIONAL SKILLS THAT INSPIRE ME

Problem solving, systems thinking, creativity, collaboration, communication, open-source contribution and continuous learning.

How this shapes my career goal

I plan to strengthen Python, SQL, databases and data structures first. After that, I want to learn data pipelines, cloud platforms, distributed systems and workflow orchestration. I also want to create practical projects, work with real datasets and eventually contribute to open-source projects. My long-term aim is to design reliable data systems that solve real-world problems.

"His journey inspires me to turn my curiosity about data into a career in Data Engineering."

Lessons I want to apply

THINK IN SYSTEMS

Look beyond a tool name. Understand the problem, the data flow, the people using the system and the reliability expected from it. Then ask what could fail, how the result is checked and how another person can understand the design.

VALUE OPEN COLLABORATION

Study how open-source projects document decisions, organise issues, review contributions and explain limitations. These habits make technical work easier for others to understand. Clear documentation and respectful review are useful skills even on a small college project.

MY NEXT PRACTICAL STEP

I can begin with a small project: explain its purpose in a README, sketch its data flow, test one core feature and document one limitation. I can also write down how to run the project and what result a reviewer should expect. This is a practical way to develop engineering habits before working with larger systems.

SECTION 03

Data Engineering Roadmap

A four-year development path with milestones, deliverables and skill priorities

YEAR 1	Programming, SQL, databases, Git/GitHub	Build foundational projects, practise consistently and establish a GitHub portfolio.	Foundational course / certificate
YEAR 2	Python, data pipelines, advanced databases, cloud fundamentals	Create data-focused projects and complete a first cloud deployment.	Entry-level cloud / data credential
YEAR 3	Cloud data systems, automation, larger projects	Build an end-to-end Data Engineering project and gain practical exposure.	Intermediate cloud / data credential
YEAR 4	Data Engineering specialization and industry preparation	Complete a capstone project and prepare an industry-ready portfolio.	Relevant advanced / specialized credential

01 FOUNDATION

Python | SQL | Git | Linux | Data Structures
Build the programming and database fundamentals required for every later stage.

02 DATA CORE

PostgreSQL | Data Modeling | ETL/ELT | APIs | CSV/JSON
Understand how raw data is stored, transformed, validated and delivered.

03 PIPELINES

Apache Airflow | dbt | Scheduling | Testing | Monitoring
Move from individual scripts to repeatable and observable workflows.

04 SCALE

Spark | Kafka | Data Lakes | Warehouses | Cloud
Develop an understanding of distributed processing, streaming and scalable storage.

05 PROOF OF WORK

Portfolio | Open Source | Internships | Real Projects
Build end-to-end projects that clearly demonstrate how data moves from a source to useful output.

"The goal is not to learn every tool. The goal is to understand data deeply enough to build reliable systems."

Roadmap review checkpoints

REVIEW WHAT I CAN SHOW

At the end of each semester, I will check four things: concepts I can explain without copying notes; exercises or projects I have completed; tests or evidence showing they work; and gaps that should guide the next stage. For a data project, I can record the input, transformation, validation check and output so another person can follow the workflow. I will adjust the tools I study according to project needs rather than trying to learn everything at once. A smaller finished project with clear documentation is more useful evidence than a long list of tools I have only tried.

SECTION 11

Professional Pitching

BHOOMI-X explained clearly in a concise 90-second structure

A professional pitch should make the audience understand the problem, the proposed solution and the practical value without unnecessary technical detail.

01 | PROBLEM

Legacy land records may contain aged documents, difficult handwriting, regional scripts and information that is hard to compare with spatial records. Manual verification can become slow when names, survey numbers, boundaries or area values need cross-checking.

02 | SOLUTION

BHOOMI-X combines multilingual OCR and multimodal AI to extract structured fields from legacy records. Confidence and consistency checks highlight uncertain information, while validated records can connect to GIS parcel data.

03 | FEASIBILITY & VALUE

The concept keeps a human verifier in control. Low-confidence or conflicting information is surfaced for review, correction or approval. The proposed stack combines a modern web interface, PostgreSQL/PostGIS, storage, audit history and verification events to create a traceable workflow.

Ready-to-deliver pitch

"BHOOMI-X is a land-record digitization and validation concept designed to turn difficult legacy documents into structured, reviewable information. It uses multilingual OCR and multimodal AI for extraction, checks confidence and consistency to identify uncertainty, and keeps a human verifier responsible for corrections. Once validated, records can be linked with GIS parcel information through survey references. The aim is to make document review faster, clearer and more traceable while keeping human judgement at the centre of the process."

Professional pitching skills

DELIVERY

Open with the real problem, speak at a steady pace, maintain eye contact, avoid excessive jargon and finish with the value of the solution.

TECHNICAL CLARITY

Be prepared to explain the role of OCR, AI, confidence checks, databases, GIS and human verification, including the limitations of the prototype.

Pitching takeaway: A strong pitch is not about describing every feature. It is about helping the audience quickly understand why the project matters, how it works and what makes the approach practical.

Questions I should be ready to answer

WHAT IS THE INPUT?

Explain what kind of legacy record enters the workflow and which fields the system is intended to identify. Mention that the quality of the source image can affect the result.

HOW IS IT CHECKED?

Describe confidence and consistency checks, and explain how uncertain or conflicting fields are flagged. The verifier should be able to inspect the original source before deciding.

WHO APPROVES IT?

Make clear that a human verifier reviews, corrects or approves information before it is treated as validated. The system supports judgement rather than replacing it.

BE CLEAR ABOUT THE PROTOTYPE

The pitch should distinguish the intended workflow from features already tested in a working prototype. State the sample data, expected output and current limitations. Avoid promising perfect recognition; explain how uncertain fields are surfaced and why human review remains necessary.

SECTION 08

SWOC Analysis & Gap-Closing Plan

A realistic assessment of my current position as an early-stage CSE student

STRENGTHS

Curiosity: willingness to explore new technologies.
Hands-on learning: projects help convert concepts into usable skills.
Persistence: continuing through difficult problems supports debugging and technical growth.
Teamwork: collaboration improves project contribution and professional communication.

WEAKNESSES

I am still developing consistency in long-term technical practice. Python proficiency is developing; SQL and database knowledge need deeper practice; exposure to real-world Data Engineering environments is limited; cloud and Data Engineering concepts remain at an early stage.

OPPORTUNITIES

Use CSE coursework and laboratories for fundamentals; build progressively harder projects; document work on GitHub; use courses and technical communities; develop professional exposure through LinkedIn, networking, hackathons and internships.

CHALLENGES

Balance academics with skill development; keep up with changing technologies without losing focus on fundamentals; gain meaningful experience while still early in college; maintain regular learning and portfolio development across four years.

Action plan: closing the gaps

Inconsistent technical practice	Follow a regular Python + SQL practice routine	End of Year 1
SQL & databases	Complete database exercises and build database projects	End of Year 1
Cloud fundamentals	Learn core cloud concepts and deploy small projects	End of Year 2
Data Engineering	Learn pipelines, data processing and data-system concepts	End of Year 3
Limited formal credentials	Complete relevant foundational cloud/data certifications	By end of Year 2

Learn -> Practice -> Build -> Document -> Validate

Progress indicators

CONSISTENCY

Track study sessions and completed exercises across weeks instead of relying on memory. A regular record makes gaps easier to notice. Set a realistic weekly target and review whether it was completed.

PROJECT EVIDENCE

Keep dated code changes, small demonstrations, test results and clear README updates. Record what each change improves, what remains unfinished and what should be tested next.

REVIEW AND ADJUST

At each review point, identify one skill that improved, one gap still affecting the work and one realistic action for the next period. Compare the plan with the evidence rather than judging progress by how busy I felt. This keeps the SWOC plan useful as an ongoing guide.

SECTION 10

Professional Development & Portfolio Summary

Technical growth supported by communication, consistency and proof of work

COMMUNICATION & TEAMWORK

Develop clear communication, teamwork and presentation skills so that I can explain technical ideas, collaborate on projects and contribute effectively in professional environments.

PROBLEM SOLVING & ADAPTABILITY

Build persistence with difficult problems, improve debugging habits and stay adaptable as tools and technologies change.

CONTINUOUS LEARNING

Use coursework, documentation, online learning, technical communities and GitHub projects to maintain steady skill development.

TIME MANAGEMENT

Balance academic responsibilities with technical practice, project building, portfolio development and co-curricular participation.

Co-curricular development

My current development activities include hackathons, technical projects, open-source/GitHub learning, professional networking and technical presentations. These activities support the transition from classroom knowledge to practical experience.

Current proof of work

PROJECTS & LEARNING

BHOOMI-X concept; Live-in-Traffic-analyser; GitHub learning; SWOC and career roadmap; SWAYAM Fundamentals of Computing.

COMMUNICATION

C1 Advanced CEFR result, supporting academic communication, professional interaction, presentations and technical documentation.

Next direction

My next priority is to build stronger foundations in Python, SQL and databases, then progress toward cloud fundamentals, data pipelines and larger end-to-end projects. By the later years of my degree, I want my portfolio to show not only what I have studied, but also what I have designed, built, tested and documented.

CONTACT

Inbathamizhan K

Email: inbathamizhan15072008@gmail.com
GitHub: inbathamizhan-tech
LinkedIn: in/inbathamizhan-k-2a5712431
St. Joseph's College of Engineering, OMR, Chennai

"Keep learning. Keep building. Keep shipping."

The evidence behind a portfolio

SHOW THE WORK, NOT JUST THE TOOL NAMES

A strong portfolio entry should state the problem, describe my role and tools, show the important workflow, explain how I tested it and note what I would improve next. Where possible, include a small demonstration or reproducible example. Clear evidence is more useful than claiming expertise in tools I am still learning.

SECTION 13

Summary of Interchange Activities

What I learnt from the Cambridge Interchange exercises

The Interchange activities helped me become more comfortable talking about past events, personal experiences and earlier routines. Instead of thinking only about grammar rules, I practised using English in situations that felt closer to everyday conversation.

Talking about past experiences

I learnt to describe completed events more clearly and to choose suitable verb forms when explaining what happened earlier. This practice also improved the way I form questions, positive statements and negative statements while speaking about past situations.

Describing earlier habits

I also practised explaining routines and situations that were common in the past but are different now. Using familiar topics such as childhood experiences made it easier to understand how these sentence patterns are used naturally in conversation.

Vocabulary & sentence accuracy

The exercises gave me repeated practice with common everyday verbs and sentence structures. I became more aware of how word choice and verb forms affect the meaning of a sentence, which helped my spoken English sound clearer and more accurate.

Confidence in communication

By connecting grammar with personal memories and simple conversations, I found it easier to express ideas without treating grammar as a separate subject. The activities encouraged me to speak with better structure and greater confidence.

My overall takeaway

Overall, these activities strengthened my ability to communicate about the past in a simple and meaningful way. I improved my understanding of sentence structure, verb forms and conversational questioning while also learning how to describe memories, old routines and changes over time. The most useful part was seeing how grammar supports real communication rather than existing only as a written rule.

"The exercises helped me connect grammar with real conversation and express past experiences more confidently."

SECTION 04

Featured Project: BHOOMI-X

From legacy land records to structured, reviewable spatial intelligence

MULTILINGUAL OCR | MULTIMODAL AI | VALIDATION | HUMAN VERIFICATION | GIS

BHOOMI-X is an intelligent land-record digitization and validation concept. It addresses the difficulty of converting aged physical records, regional handwriting and disconnected textual information into structured records that can be reviewed and connected to parcel geography.

WHY THE PROBLEM IS DIFFICULT

Fragile records: aged registers and deteriorating documents.
Complex handwriting: regional scripts and inconsistent writing make extraction difficult.
Manual verification: reviewers spend significant time comparing records.
Disconnected spatial data: textual records and parcel geography are difficult to connect.

PROJECT GOAL

Create one reviewable workflow from physical document to structured data and GIS intelligence. AI assists with extraction, confidence scoring and consistency checks, while human verification remains central to uncertain or conflicting fields.

What the system is designed to do

EXTRACT

Use image processing, multilingual OCR and multimodal AI to understand handwriting and extract fields such as owner, survey number, village, district, area and registration information.

VALIDATE

Apply confidence scoring and consistency checks across survey number, owner-name similarity, dates, boundaries, geography and area values.

REVIEW

Route uncertain fields and potential discrepancies to a verifier. The reviewer can approve, edit or flag information, keeping the process human-reviewable.

CONNECT

Link a validated record through its survey number to spatial references and parcel geography, making the information useful for GIS-based review.

Prototype validation priorities

EXTRACTION QUALITY

Use representative sample pages and check whether important fields are captured correctly. Record unreadable or ambiguous fields instead of guessing. Compare extracted fields with a manually checked reference.

CONSISTENCY CHECKS

Test missing values, conflicting names, date formats and area values. Show why a record is flagged so a reviewer can inspect it. Each warning should be understandable, not just a colour or score.

REVIEWER CONTROL

Show the source and extracted value together. Allow corrections and keep a clear record of review and approval. A reviewer should be able to see what changed and why.

GIS CONNECTION

Link only approved records through the appropriate survey reference, then check that the selected parcel matches the intended record. Treat a missing or ambiguous match as a review case.

SECTION 07

GitHub & Practical Learning

Building projects to strengthen software engineering and data-system fundamentals

My GitHub profile reflects a build-first approach. I am exploring full-stack development, real-time systems, maps and practical products while improving programming, databases, data structures and modern web technologies.

FEATURED PROJECT

Live-in-Traffic-analyser
A Pan-India real-time traffic monitoring platform for drivers, commuters and planners. The concept brings live traffic information, incident reporting and analytics together in a mobile-friendly experience.

WHY I BUILT IT

The project gives me a practical environment to connect frontend interfaces, backend communication, databases, mapping and real-time updates. It helps turn separate technical concepts into one working-system mindset.

What it includes

USER EXPERIENCE

Live traffic maps for road conditions; traffic alerts and incident reports; responsive mobile-friendly access for users on the move.

REAL-TIME & ANALYTICS

Traffic analytics to understand patterns and WebSocket-powered updates to support real-time information flow.

Technology stack

Frontend	React, Next.js, responsive interfaces, Leaflet / Mapbox
Backend	Node.js, APIs, WebSockets, authentication and server design
Data	PostgreSQL, PostGIS, Redis
Workflow	Git, GitHub, debugging, documentation and collaboration
Foundations	CSE fundamentals, data structures and problem solving

What I would test in a prototype

MAP AND DATA QUALITY

Check that each map item uses the correct location and that the information shown can be traced to its data source. Verify that the map and accompanying details refer to the same event.

REAL-TIME UPDATES

Test connection interruptions, repeated events and delayed messages so the interface does not present outdated information as current. Provide a clear state when live updates are unavailable.

INCIDENT REPORTING

Check that reports contain useful details, can be reviewed and are not treated as confirmed facts without validation. Make the difference between a submitted report and a verified incident clear.

USABILITY

Try key tasks on a smaller screen and make sure alerts, map controls and text remain understandable. Check that essential information is not hidden by controls or notifications.

LEARNING OUTCOME

These checks connect the frontend, APIs, database, mapping and real-time messaging into one dependable workflow. They also give me specific issues to investigate, test and document as the project develops.

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NPTEL STUDY NOTES | WEEK 1 - LECTURE 1

Week 1 - Lecture 1 | Introduction 1: Highlights of Developing Soft Skills

Course: Enhancing Soft Skills and Personality (IIT Kanpur, Prof. T. Ravichandran). These are expanded study notes derived from the lecture themes in the uploaded portfolios, not proof of course completion.

Concept explained

Soft skills influence how knowledge becomes useful in daily life. Communication, listening, responsibility and the ability to work with other people affect both study and employment. The introductory session connects these habits with individual character and the decision to improve deliberately.

Why this matters

Technical ability is not enough on its own. An accurate explanation of a solution, an honest response to criticism, and a calm conversation in a team are also evidence of professional growth.

My understanding

I would describe the principle through the choices I make each day, rather than through a single examination result.

Connection to my own studies

I want to work toward data engineering and cloud systems, so I need to explain technical decisions in understandable language. For example, when presenting the BHOOMI-X mapping/data project, I should describe the problem, my method and what I learned.

Example in practice

During a group assignment, I can listen to the full requirement, summarise it in my own words and ask whether I understood it correctly. When I explain a technical choice, I should connect it to the problem and avoid assuming that everyone shares the same background knowledge.

Reflection: Did I understand the other person's point before responding?

Practical action: Notice how I respond when someone disagrees with an idea; practise listening first and summarising their point before answering.

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NPTEL STUDY NOTES | WEEK 2 - LECTURE 2

Week 2 - Lecture 2 | Introduction 2: Further Highlights of Developing Soft Skills

Course: Enhancing Soft Skills and Personality (IIT Kanpur, Prof. T. Ravichandran). These are expanded study notes derived from the lecture themes in the uploaded portfolios, not proof of course completion.

Concept explained

The second introductory lecture builds on personal development. It places attention on self-awareness, preparation, ethical conduct, listening, communication and the willingness to examine one's own behaviour. Progress is more realistic when a person observes habits instead of relying only on good intentions.

Why this matters

A conversation has a purpose, an audience and an expected result. Choosing precise words and checking understanding makes both presentations and everyday teamwork more effective.

My understanding

The material encouraged me to work deliberately, review my behaviour and make one measurable adjustment at a time.

Connection to my own studies

As I strengthen programming, databases and cloud development, I can practise concise presentations and active listening. A good team discussion should leave everyone knowing the next action, not merely the words that were spoken.

Example in practice

Before a presentation, I can identify the audience, main message and expected next step. In teamwork, I can communicate progress honestly, give credit for others' contributions and raise uncertainty early instead of hiding it.

Reflection: After a discussion, could every team member name the next action?

Practical action: After one class discussion, write down what I explained clearly, what confused others, and one small adjustment for next time.

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NPTEL STUDY NOTES | WEEK 3 - LECTURE 3

Week 3 - Lecture 3 | Mindset 1: Definition and Types

Course: Enhancing Soft Skills and Personality (IIT Kanpur, Prof. T. Ravichandran). These are expanded study notes derived from the lecture themes in the uploaded portfolios, not proof of course completion.

Concept explained

A mindset refers to the beliefs and assumptions through which a person interprets experiences. A positive outlook encourages effort, but an unexamined negative assumption can discourage action before a problem is even attempted. Mindsets influence reactions to success, mistakes, advice and unfamiliar situations.

Why this matters

Recognising a limiting belief is different from pretending difficulties do not exist. I can acknowledge that a topic is challenging and still choose to attempt a smaller, achievable step.

My understanding

I understood the central message as a reminder to turn an idea into a habit, not simply memorise a definition.

Connection to my own studies

When progress on the BHOOMI-X mapping/data project is slow, I should question the assumption that a first attempt must be perfect. Breaking a complex problem into smaller parts makes the challenge easier to investigate.

Example in practice

When a task seems difficult, separate the goal into smaller questions. Identify what is known, test one assumption at a time and use the result to decide the next step. This keeps effort directed without pretending that every attempt will work.

Reflection: What is the smallest useful step I can test next?

Practical action: Identify one sentence I use when a task feels hard, then rewrite it as a realistic statement about a skill I can practise.

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NPTEL STUDY NOTES | WEEK 4 - LECTURE 4

Week 4 - Lecture 4 | Mindset 2: Learning Mindsets

Course: Enhancing Soft Skills and Personality (IIT Kanpur, Prof. T. Ravichandran). These are expanded study notes derived from the lecture themes in the uploaded portfolios, not proof of course completion.

Concept explained

The learning-mindset lecture distinguishes responses that close off improvement from responses that welcome it. A fixed outlook may treat errors as proof of inability; a growth-oriented approach treats them as feedback about a method, strategy or level of preparation.

Why this matters

Progress in a difficult subject usually requires several attempts, good feedback and corrections. This does not guarantee immediate success, but it encourages sustained, thoughtful practice.

My understanding

The main lesson for me is that a useful skill appears in ordinary actions, especially when circumstances become demanding.

Connection to my own studies

If I cannot solve a task using programming, databases and cloud development immediately, I will experiment with examples, read feedback carefully and retry. The main evidence of improvement is a better method after each attempt.

Example in practice

If a SQL query returns an unexpected result, I can inspect the input rows, join conditions, filters and expected output one at a time. A correction then becomes evidence of a better method, not simply a mark against the first attempt.

Reflection: What did I change, and how did I verify the result?

Practical action: When an exercise fails, record the cause, try a second method, and describe what changed rather than merely recording a wrong answer.

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NPTEL STUDY NOTES | WEEK 5 - LECTURE 5

Week 5 - Lecture 5 | Mindset 3: Secrets of Developing Growth Mindsets

Course: Enhancing Soft Skills and Personality (IIT Kanpur, Prof. T. Ravichandran). These are expanded study notes derived from the lecture themes in the uploaded portfolios, not proof of course completion.

Concept explained

This session focuses on building a growth mindset through purposeful effort, reflection and practical goals. Improvement becomes more visible when long ambitions are divided into small tasks and when feedback is used to modify the approach rather than judge personal worth.

Why this matters

The word “yet” helps reframe an unfinished skill, but a useful growth mindset also requires evidence: repeated practice, specific study methods and honest review of results.

My understanding

This discussion made me compare the way I think about a challenge with the steps I actually take to solve it.

Connection to my own studies

My plan to develop in data engineering and cloud systems benefits from frequent practice. I can track a practical target, such as solving a set of small coding problems or improving one feature in the BHOOMI-X mapping/data project.

Example in practice

I can choose one manageable weekly outcome, such as completing a set of SQL exercises, documenting a Python bug or improving one project feature. I should write down the starting point and compare the final result with it.

Reflection: Can I point to a completed result from this week's goal?

Practical action: Set one weekly skill goal, complete three practice attempts and compare the final attempt with the first.

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NPTEL STUDY NOTES | WEEK 6 - LECTURE 6

Week 6 - Lecture 6 | Managing Time 1: Importance and Perceptions of Time

Course: Enhancing Soft Skills and Personality (IIT Kanpur, Prof. T. Ravichandran). These are expanded study notes derived from the lecture themes in the uploaded portfolios, not proof of course completion.

Concept explained

Time is limited, and different activities compete for it. This lecture asks learners to consider how they perceive time and where their hours go. Without first observing real habits, a timetable may become unrealistic or fail to account for interruptions.

Why this matters

Time management starts with awareness. Planning can balance urgent work, long-term learning, breaks and responsibilities while leaving room to adjust when a task takes longer than expected.

My understanding

I can relate this topic to preparing for a technical career while still developing my fundamentals.

Connection to my own studies

When juggling classes and programming, databases and cloud development, I need an honest picture of my schedule. I can compare planned study time with what I actually use, then adjust without removing necessary rest.

Example in practice

A realistic review can separate class time, focused study, project work, travel and breaks. Comparing planned and actual time helps me see where tasks take longer than expected and where I need a buffer.

Reflection: Which task needs a different estimate or an earlier start?

Practical action: Record one study day in half-hour blocks, identify avoidable delays and reserve a fixed period for a priority task.

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NPTEL STUDY NOTES | WEEK 7 - LECTURE 7

Week 7 - Lecture 7 | Managing Time 2: Using Time Efficiently

Course: Enhancing Soft Skills and Personality (IIT Kanpur, Prof. T. Ravichandran). These are expanded study notes derived from the lecture themes in the uploaded portfolios, not proof of course completion.

Concept explained

Efficient time use means selecting priorities, estimating effort and limiting distractions. Working for many hours is not the same as producing good work. Concentrated sessions, realistic deadlines and checking completed tasks can improve the use of available time.

Why this matters

A short task list works best when it names a concrete output rather than an unclear intention. Reviewing progress also reveals which tasks repeatedly need more time.

My understanding

The lecture showed me that knowing a rule and consistently following it are two different things.

Connection to my own studies

To make steady progress toward data engineering and cloud systems, I should rank important tasks, avoid constant switching and set a visible result for each study session, such as a tested function or a written explanation.

Example in practice

Before starting, define what completion looks like: a tested function, a corrected query, a finished slide or a short written explanation. At the end of the session, mark what is complete and record the next action for unfinished work.

Reflection: What can I show at the end of this session?

Practical action: Choose three tasks for tomorrow, estimate minutes for each, finish the most important one early and review actual times.

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VOCABULARY WORK SHEET

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

Complete the sentences using the correct terms from Units 1, 2, and 3.

1. To find out what someone's job is, you usually ask, ·What do you do?·
2. A manager who oversees a team and ensures targets are met is often said to be in charge of the department.
3. Employees who work outside standard office hours in rotation (e.g., one week morning, next week evening) are working in shifts.
4. Outside specialists hired by companies to persuade top executives to leave their current firms are known as headhunters.
5. Job applicants typically submit a CV (curriculum vitae) detailing the story of their working life alongside a covering letter.

Part B: Matching Terms to Definitions

Match each business term on the left with its correct description on the right.

1. B_____ Flexitime
2. C_____ Teleworking
3. E_____ Psychometric test
4. D_____ Shortlist
5. A_____ Referees

- **A.** Previous employers or teachers named to provide character or performance references.
- **B.** A system allowing employees to choose working hours within agreed limits.
- **C.** Working from home using a computer and telecommunications.
- **D.** A selected pool of qualified candidates chosen for final interviews.
- **E.** A written test used to assess a candidate's intelligence and personality.

Part C: Sentence Correction

Identify and correct the errors in the following sentences.

1. *Error:* "I am in charge for the design department." → *Correction:* I am in charge of the design department.

VOCABULARY PRACTICE | WORKSHEET 02

2. *Error:* "He is going to the work by train every morning." → *Correction:*
   He goes to work by train every morning.
3. *Error:* "She is a very responsible in her daily tasks." → *Correction:*
   She is very responsible in her daily tasks.

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

Complete the sentences using the correct terms from Units 4 and 5.

1. Someone who has just left university with a degree is referred to as a graduate.
2. A worker who requires virtually no specialized training or formal qualifications is classified as unskilled.
3. Salespeople often receive a basic salary plus commission, which is a percentage on everything they sell.
4. Senior executives may receive share (stock) options, giving them the right to buy company shares at low prices.
5. High-ranking corporate executives with excessive compensation packages are sometimes referred to informally as fat cats.

Part B: Matching Collocations

Match the adjectives/phrases on the left with their correct prepositional complements.

1. E_____ Skilled _____
2. D_____ Good _____
3. A_____ Computer _____
4. B_____ Self _____
5. C_____ Fringe _____

- **A.** literate
- **B.** starter / motivated
- **C.** benefits
- **D.** at / in
- **E.** with

Part C: Application & Context Analysis

Explain the difference between the following pairs in 1-2 sentences:

1. **Salary vs. Wages:**
   A salary is normally a fixed regular payment, often monthly; wages are usually calculated by hours or days worked.
   _____
2. **Severance package vs. Bonus:**
   A severance package is compensation given when employment ends; a bonus is extra pay for performance or results.
   _____

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

VOCABULARY PRACTICE | WORKSHEET 03

Complete the sentences using terms from Units 6, 7, and 8.

1. Manual workers who use their hands and wear blue collars are often contrasted with white-collar workers in offices.
2. When workers stop working temporarily to protest pay or conditions, they go on strike.
3. A company that reduces its management layers and makes itself leaner is said to have delayered.
4. When an employee is dismissed through no fault of their own because their job no longer exists, they are made redundant.
5. An invisible barrier that prevents women from rising beyond a certain corporate level is called the _ glass __ ceiling.

Part B: Matching Health & Safety / Legal Terms

Match each workplace issue with its accurate classification.

1. B_____ Repetitive Strain Injury (RSI)
2. D_____ Passive smoking
3. A_____ Sexual harassment
4. C_____ Equal opportunities
5. E_____ Whistleblowing

- **A.** Unwelcome sexual behavior in the workplace
- **B.** Physical injury caused by continuous data entry or typing
- **C.** British term equivalent to US affirmative action
- **D.** Breathing in other people's tobacco smoke involuntarily
- **E.** Reporting illegal or unethical practices within an organization

Part C: Short Answer Exercises

1. What is the difference between being **dismissed** and being **made redundant**?
   Dismissal means an employer ends someone's employment, often because of conduct or performance. Redundancy happens when the job itself is no longer needed.
   _____
2. What is an **open-plan office**?
   An open-plan office is a shared workspace with few or no dividing walls between desks.
   _____

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

Complete the sentences using terms from Units 9, 10, and 11.

1. Directors who are outsiders and do not participate in the day-to-day running of the company are non-executive directors.
2. In the US, the top manager is often the CEO, while chief operating officers (COOs) take care of the day-to-day running.

3. Someone who founds or establishes their own company and takes financial risks is an entrepreneur.
4. Powerful leaders who control massive business empires are often called magnates, moguls, or tycoons.
5. Businesses that are sold off by the state to private investors are privatized.

Part B: Matching Corporate Terms

Match the terms on the left with their definitions.

1. A_____ SME
2. D_____ Corporate culture
3. E_____ Enterprise zone
4. B_____ Head up
5. C_____ Boardroom

- **A.** Small and Medium-sized Enterprise
- **B.** To head or lead a department or activity
- **C.** The room where directors meet
- **D.** The shared beliefs and working style of a company
- **E.** A designated region with fewer laws and lower taxes to encourage business

Part C: Error Correction

Correct the italicized phrases:

1. "He is the head up of our marketing department." →
   He heads up our marketing department.
2. "We need to buy a commerce for our new online shop." →
   We need to set up an e-commerce business for our new online shop.

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

Complete the sentences using terms from Units 12, 13, and 14.

1. A self-employed person working alone, especially a builder or plumber, is a sole trader.
2. A company whose shares can be freely bought and sold on the stock market is a Public Limited Company or PLC.
3. Organizations with social aims like helping the sick or poor are non-profit organizations or charities.
4. Software developers often release a final test version, called a beta version, before official launch.
5. If a design defect is discovered after a product launch, a company may have to recall it.

Part B: Sector Classification

VOCABULARY PRACTICE | WORKSHEET 05

*Classify each industry as either **Manufacturing (M)** or **Services (S)**.*

1. 1·M Aerospace
2. 2·S Catering
3. 3·M Pharmaceuticals
4. 4·S Property / Real Estate
5. 5·M Steel production

Part C: Short Definitions

1. Define **CADCAM**:
   CADCAM means Computer-Aided Design and Computer-Aided Manufacturing; computers help design and produce goods.
   _____
2. Define **Focus group**:
   A focus group is a small group of people asked to discuss a product, idea, or advertisement to provide feedback.
   _____

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

Complete the sentences using terms from Units 15, 16, and 17.

1. Products that are no longer up-to-date because they use old technology are obsolete.
2. Legal protection for an invention that stops others from copying its design is a patent.
3. The maximum amount that a plant or company can produce is its capacity.
4. Materials, components, labor, and capital used in production are collectively known as inputs.
5. Manufacturing goods efficiently without waste by having components arrive exactly when needed is just-in-time (JIT) production.

Part B: Matching Terms

1. B_____ R&D
2. A_____ Royalties
3. C_____ Craft industry
4. E_____ Work-in-progress
5. D_____ Outsourcing

- **A.** Payments made to an author or inventor for using their protected work
- **B.** Research and Development department
- **C.** Manual, labor-intensive production of items like furniture
- **D.** Using outside suppliers for services previously done in-house
- **E.** Goods that are currently being made on the production line

Part C: Short Explanations

VOCABULARY PRACTICE | WORKSHEET 06

1. Why do companies implement **Just-in-Time (JIT)** manufacturing?
   Companies use JIT to reduce inventory and storage costs, minimize waste, and receive materials only when they are needed.

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

Complete the sentences using terms from Units 18, 19, and 20.

1. The objective of quality control is conformance to specifications with zero defects.
2. Comparing your performance against the best operators in the industry is called benchmarking.
3. People who buy everyday services like train travel are customers, while those who buy professional services are clients.
4. A company that sells more than any other competitor in a market is the market leader.
5. When competition is extremely strong and aggressive, it is often described as cut-throat or fierce.

Part B: Matching Terms

1. B_____ Kaizen
2. C_____ Mystery shopper
3. E_____ Market segment
4. D_____ Key players
5. A_____ BPR

- **A.** Business Process Re-engineering
- **B.** Japanese term for continuous improvement
- **C.** Person pretending to be a customer to check service quality
- **D.** The most important companies in a particular market
- **E.** A distinct group of buyers targeted within a market

Part C: Analysis Task

1. What is the difference between a **market leader** and a **challenger**?
   A market leader has the largest market share; a challenger is a competitor trying to increase its share and overtake the leader.

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

1. The four Ps of marketing are product, price, place, and promotion.
2. Consumer goods that last a long time, such as cars and washing machines, are consumer durables.
3. Products that do not have a brand name are known as unbranded products or generics.
4. Cheap items sold at or below cost to attract customers into a store are loss leaders.

VOCABULARY PRACTICE | WORKSHEET 07

5.· A small group of buyers with specialized needs forms a niche market.

Part B: Matching Terms

1. A_____ FMCG
2. B_____ Own-brand
3. D_____ Upmarket
4. C_____ Trade up
5. E_____ Price war

- **A.** Fast-Moving Consumer Goods (fast-selling items like food)
- **B.** Products sold under the retailer's own name
- **C.** Moving from basic models to more sophisticated, expensive ones
- **D.** Designed for higher-income users; upscale
- **E.** When competing companies continually reduce prices in response to each other

Part C: Short Answer

1. Name the **Four Ps** of the marketing mix:
   Product, Price, Place and Promotion.

_____

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

Complete the sentences using terms from Units 24, 25, and 26.

1.· Wholesalers and retailers are collectively known as intermediaries.
2.· A retail store that is part of a group of shops all sharing the same name is a chain store.
3. Unsolicited direct mail sent to consumers' homes is often dismissively called junk mail.
4. A series of advertisements for a particular product or company is an advertising campaign.
5. Businesses combining traditional physical shops with online e-commerce operations practice bricks-and-mortar retail.

Part B: Matching Terms

1. C_____ Cold call
2. E_____ Franchise
3. A_____ Billboard (AmE)
4. D_____ Loyalty card
5. B_____ B2B

- **A.** Open-air hoarding used for advertising
- **B.** Business-to-Business e-procurement
- **C.** Unannounced sales phone call to someone with no prior contact

VOCABULARY PRACTICE | WORKSHEET 08

- **D.** Card offering reward points based on customer spending
- **E.** Business format run by a franchisee under a franchisor's brand

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

1. Money received from sales is known as revenue or turnover.
2. Costs that do not change when production goes up or down (e.g., rent) are fixed costs.
3. Products that have very good profitability and generate large cash surpluses are cash cows.
4. Customers who owe money to a business are recorded as accounts receivable.
5. Independent outside accountants who examine a company's accounts to see if they give a true and fair view are auditors.

Part B: Matching Financial Terms

1. A_____ COGS
2. C_____ Goodwill
3. B_____ Depreciation
4. E_____ In the red
5. D_____ Window dressing

- **A.** Cost of Goods Sold (variable manufacturing costs)
- **B.** Reduction in the book value of fixed assets over time
- **C.** An intangible asset representing a company's good reputation
- **D.** Creative accounting making results look better than they are
- **E.** Operating at a financial loss or having a negative bank balance

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

1. The person who is in charge of running a meeting and keeping participants on track is the chairperson or chair, often referred to simply as the chair.

2. A list of items to be discussed during a meeting, sent out in advance, is called the agenda.

3. When negotiators or meeting participants reach a middle-ground solution where both sides make concessions, they reach a compromise.

4. Using cautious language to avoid making overly direct or absolute statements is known in discussion techniques as hedging.

5. When a meeting discussion completely breaks down and no agreement can be reached, it is referred to as a deadlock.

VOCABULARY PRACTICE | WORKSHEET 09

Part B: Matching Meeting Terms

1. _C_____ AGM
2. _E_____ Minutes
3. _A_____ Consensus
4. _B_____ Action points
5. _D_____ Hedging

- **A.** General agreement reached by all participants
- **B.** Specific tasks assigned to individuals to complete after a meeting finishes
- **C.** Annual General Meeting held once a year for shareholders
- **D.** Avoiding direct or committal statements using qualifying language
- **E.** The written record of decisions and discussions made during a meeting

Part C: Short Answer Exercises

1. What is the main responsibility of a meeting chairperson before a meeting begins?
The chairperson should plan the meeting, prepare an agenda and ensure participants receive the relevant information in advance.

2. What is the difference between reaching a **consensus** and voting on a decision?
Consensus means the group reaches general agreement through discussion; voting decides an issue by counting individual choices.

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

1. The visual items used during a presentation, such as slides, handouts, or overhead projections, are called visual aids.
2. Establishing a positive connection and good mutual relationship with your audience during a presentation is building rapport.
3. The opening part of a presentation where you welcome the audience and outline your structure is the introduction.
4. Moving around too much or making nervous hand gestures can distract from your body language during a speech.

VOCABULARY PRACTICE | WORKSHEET 10

5. When concluding a presentation, speakers typically open the floor to deal with questions from the audience.

Part B: Matching Presentation Stages

1. _C_____ Visual aids
2. _B_____ Body language
3. _D_____ Rapport
4. _E_____ Q&A session
5. _A_____ Handouts

- **A.** Printed materials distributed to listeners to supplement a presentation
- **B.** Postures, gestures, and facial expressions used while speaking
- **C.** Charts, slides, and diagrams used to illustrate key points visually
- **D.** A harmonious, trusting relationship between speaker and listeners
- **E.** The time at the end of a presentation dedicated to answering inquiries

Part C: Error Correction

Correct the italicized phrases:

1. "During my presentation, I will show you some visual supports." → During my presentation, I will show you some visual aids.

2. "Let's open the floor for some inquiries from the spectators." → Let's open the floor for questions from the audience.

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

Complete the sentences using terms from Units 62 through 66.

1. A negotiation style where both sides aim for an outcome that benefits everyone involved is known as a win-win situation.

2. Offering something you value less in exchange for something the other party values less during talks is making trade-offs.

3. When negotiations completely stall and neither side is willing to move or compromise, they have reached a deadlock.

VOCABULARY PRACTICE | WORKSHEET 11

4. An agreement between two or more parties that is enforceable by law after a successful negotiation is a contract.

5. A neutral third party brought in to help resolve a deadlock and mediate an agreement is a mediator.

Part B: Matching Negotiation Tactics

1. _A_____ Probing
2. _D_____ Counter-proposal
3. _B_____ Deadlock
4. _E_____ Concession
5. _C_____ Mediator

- **A.** Asking probing questions to discover the other party's underlying needs
- **B.** A stall in talks where neither side will compromise
- **C.** An independent third party assisting in dispute resolution
- **DT.** A responding offer made in reaction to an initial proposal
- **E.** Something given up voluntarily to reach an agreement

Part C: Short Answer Exercises

1. What is the difference between a **hard bargaining** style and a **win-win** style?
Hard bargaining focuses on winning as much as possible for
one side; a win-win style seeks a mutually beneficial agreement.
_____

2. Why is checking the final contract details essential after reaching an agreement?
Checking contract details ensures that all terms are accurate,
understood, lawful, and consistent with what was agreed.
_____

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

VOCABULARY PRACTICE | WORKSHEET 12

Complete the sentences using terms from Units 36 and 37.

1. When a company sells its shares to the public for the first time, it floats the company in a flotation / initial public offering (IPO).

2. Short-term lending to businesses is known as commercial credit.

3. Financial products derived from underlying assets, such as futures and options contracts, are known as derivatives.

4. An extended period of rising share prices and optimistic dealer sentiment is referred to as a bull market.

5. Shares in long-established, stable companies with a history of profit in both good and bad times are called blue chips.

Part B: Matching Financial Markets

1. B_____ Forex

2. C_____ Bourse

3. A_____ NASDAQ

4. E_____ FTSE

5. D_____ Bear market

- **A.** New York stock market index focusing heavily on high-tech companies
- **B.** Foreign exchange market for buying and selling national currencies
- **C.** An alternative term for a stock market or stock exchange
- **D.** A market characterized by falling prices and pessimistic dealer sentiment
- **E.** London's Financial Times Stock Exchange index

Part C: Short Answer Exercises

1. What is the difference between a **futures contract** and an **options contract**?
A futures contract generally obliges the parties to transact later at agreed terms; an option gives its buyer the right, but not the obligation, to transact.
_____

2. Why are major financial centres like London and New York often referred to by nicknames like "The City" or "Wall Street"?

VOCABULARY PRACTICE | WORKSHEET 13

The City and Wall Street are famous financial districts, so their names are used as shorthand for the financial industries based there.

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

1. The study of how money works, is used, and whether economic activities are profitable is called economics.

2. When a country exports more goods and services than it imports, it maintains a trade surplus.

3. The total monetary value of all goods and services produced within a particular country is its Gross Domestic Product (GDP).

4. A period of negative economic growth where economic output contracts is known as a recession.

5. When a bad recession becomes extremely severe, widespread, and prolonged, it is called a slump or depression.

Part B: Matching Economic Indicators

1. _C_ inflation rate ion rate
2. _D_ Trade deficit
3. _E_ Stagflation
4. _B_ Trough
5. _A_ Stagnation

- **A.** A period when the economy is growing very slowly or not at all
- **B.** The lowest point in an economic cycle before output starts rising again
- **C.** The speed at which general consumer price levels are rising
- **D.** When import payments exceed export earnings, creating a trade gap
- **E.** A difficult economic condition combining slow growth with rapid inflation

Part C: Error Correction

VOCABULARY PRACTICE | WORKSHEET 14

Correct the italicized phrases:

1. "The country's economic indicators show a high rate of inflation speeds." → The country's economic indicators show a high rate of inflation.

2. "When output reaches its lowest level, it hits a peak before rising." → When output reaches its lowest level, it hits a trough before rising.

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

1. Buying or selling securities using confidential information that is not publicly available is illegal insider dealing.

2. A secret agreement among competing companies in the same market to fix prices at a certain level is price fixing.

3. A type of fraud where an employee illegally steals and gets money from their employer is known as embezzlement.

4. The process of hiding the illegal origin of criminal money, often by purchasing property, is money laundering.

5. Directing investment funds exclusively into companies that do not harm people or the environment is ethical investment.

Part B: Matching Crime & Ethics Terms

1. _D_____ Embezzlement

2. _A_____ Counterfeiting

3. _B_____ Bribery

4. _E_____ Code of ethics

5. _C_____ Sweatshop labor

- **A.** Making illegal fake copies of banknotes, documents, or luxury goods
- **B.** Offering or receiving illegal payments to persuade someone to act corruptly
- **C.** Manual labor performed under severely exploitative, underpaid conditions
- **D.** The illegal theft of funds by someone entrusted with managing them within a firm
- **E.** A formal corporate document outlining required moral standards of behavior

VOCABULARY PRACTICE | WORKSHEET 15

Part C: Short Answer Exercises

1. What is the purpose of establishing **Chinese walls** within financial institutions?
Chinese walls separate departments and restrict confidential information to prevent conflicts of interest and insider dealing.

2. Why do institutional investors conduct annual **social performance audits**?
Social performance audits check whether companies meet ethical, social and environmental standards and help investors assess risks.

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

1. The overall period during which a project or task should be completed is referred to as the timescale or timeframe.

2. When work is completed later than the planned completion date, it is behind schedule and there is a delay.

3. Work that is difficult in an interesting, rewarding, and enjoyable way is described as challenging.

4. An extreme state of physical and mental exhaustion caused by chronic work stress is known as burnout.

5. The metaphor used to describe the exhausting, highly competitive modern corporate work environment is the rat race.

Part B: Matching Time & Stress Terms

1. D Downtime
2. E Prioritize
3. C Perfectionism
4. A Downshifting
5. B Stress-induced

- **A.** Choosing to leave behind a stressful career for a simpler, balanced lifestyle
- **B.** An unexpected illness or condition brought on by excessive pressure
- **C.** An unworkable aim for flawlessness when there is no need for it

VOCABULARY PRACTICE | WORKSHEET 16

- **D.** Periods when machinery or computers cannot operate because they are broken
- **E.** Arranging tasks in order of importance before working on them

Part C: Short Answer Exercises

1. What are the key dangers of striving for **perfectionism** when managing daily tasks?
Perfectionism can waste time, delay deadlines, increase stress and reduce productivity by focusing too much on minor details.

2. How do **downshifters** typically redefine their personal idea of success?
Downshifters often define success through well-being, family time, balance and satisfaction rather than salary or status.

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

1. People working below a manager in an organizational hierarchy are known as subordinates.
2. A leadership quality that is forward-thinking, with the power to see clearly how things will be in the future, is called being a visionary.
3. Management decisions that are arrived at by asking employees to contribute in a process of consultation are built on consultation.
4. Granting employees the initiative and authority to make decisions without asking managers first is called empowerment.
5. A corporate environment characterized by male dominance, aggressiveness, and physical strength is a macho culture.

Part B: Matching Leadership & Cultural Terms

1. B Authoritarian
2. E Decentralized
3. D Deference
4. C Corporate culture
5. A Canteen culture

- **A.** Unofficial, unapproved ways that people within an organization think and talk

- **B.** A management style that imposes decisions from above without consultation
- **C.** The shared values, habits, and working style of a specific company
- **D.** Respectful submission and yielding to the authority of superiors
- **E.** Organizational structures where decision-making authority is spread out

Part C: Error Correction

Correct the italicized phrases:

1. "The manager is very remote, so she is completely approachable by all staff." → The manager is very approachable, so all staff feel comfortable speaking to her.

2. "We operate a top-down consensus approach in our department." → We use a consultative, consensus-based approach in our department.

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

Complete the sentences using terms from Units 46, 47, and 48.

1. In the English-speaking business world, people routinely use first names even when they do not know each other very well.

2. A company day where employees are allowed to wear less formal clothing than a standard business suit is called a casual Friday.

3. Being at work when you do not actually need to be there, simply to demonstrate commitment, is known as a culture of presenteeism.

4. A phone extension that is not connected by a physical wire, allowing movement around a home or office, is a cordless phone.

5. A phone number that provides free access for callers, such as an 0800 number, is a toll-free number.

Part B: Matching Etiquette Terms

1. B Surname
2. E Smart casual
3. D Punctuality
4. C Pager

5. AVideoconferencing

- **A.** Holding a face-to-face meeting across locations using computers and cameras
- **B.** A family name shared across relatives
- **C.** A device that receives written messages while on the move
- **D.** Arriving at meetings or appointments on time
- **E.** A relaxed yet professional style of dress that avoids full suits

Part C: Short Answer Exercises

1. What is the standard convention regarding names in the English-speaking business world?
In many English-speaking workplaces, colleagues often use first names, even when they do not know each other well.

2. How do attitudes toward **time** and schedules vary across different business cultures? Some business cultures value strict punctuality and fixed schedules, while others take a more flexible approach to time.

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

1. A formal meeting open to all shareholders of a company held once a year is an Annual General Meeting or AGM.

2. Before a meeting begins, the chairperson prepares a list of items to be discussed, known as the agenda.

3. During a meeting, the person taking notes records the decisions and discussions to produce the official minutes.

4. When a chairperson wants to open a meeting or direct attention to the first item, the chairperson formally opens the meeting.

5. Inviting specific participants to speak during a discussion helps ensure everyone has an opportunity to share their views.

Part B: Matching Meeting Terms

1. C Chairperson
2. E Agenda
3. D Minutes

VOCABULARY PRACTICE | WORKSHEET 19

4. B Action points

5. A Venue

- **A.** The official physical or virtual location where a meeting takes place
- **B.** Specific tasks assigned to individuals to execute after the meeting concludes
- **C.** The person responsible for running the meeting and keeping order
- **D.** The written record of what was discussed and decided
- **E.** The structured list of topics scheduled for discussion

Part C: Short Answer Exercises

1. What are the key responsibilities of a chairperson *during* a meeting?
The chairperson opens and guides the meeting, follows the agenda, manages time, encourages participation and summarizes decisions.

2. Why is it important to distribute an agenda well in advance of a meeting?
An agenda sent early helps participants prepare, gather information and make the meeting more efficient.

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

1. Using cautious language and qualifying phrases to avoid making overly direct or absolute statements is called hedging.

2. A negotiation approach where both parties work to find solutions that benefit everyone involved is a win-win situation.

3. Asking detailed and probing questions during negotiations helps uncover the other party's underlying needs.

4. When negotiators offer something they value less in exchange for a concession from the other side, they are making trade-offs.

5. When a negotiation stalls completely because neither side will compromise or move forward, they have reached a deadlock.

Part B: Matching Discussion & Negotiation Terms

1. D Hedging

2. C Consensus

VOCABULARY PRACTICE | WORKSHEET 20

3. E Probing

4. B Counter-proposal

5. A Mediator

- **A.** An independent third party brought in to help resolve a deadlock
- **B.** A responding offer made in reaction to an initial bargaining position
- **C.** General agreement reached collectively by all participants
- **D.** Using cautious, non-committal language to soften statements
- **E.** Asking exploratory questions to investigate underlying interests

Part C: Error Correction

Correct the italicized phrases:

1. "We reached a deadlock, so we made a win-win compromise that pleased nobody." → We avoided deadlock by reaching a win-win compromise that satisfied both sides.

2. "During the meeting, he used too much hedging so his point was extremely direct and clear." → During the meeting, he used very little hedging, so his point was direct and clear.

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

1. A brief presentation given to inform colleagues or clients about a specific project update or status report is often structured around different types of presentations, such as a product launch.

2. When preparing a presentation, speakers should practice to ensure proper timing, avoiding rushing through the material or exceeding the allocated time.

3. Maintaining eye contact, varying vocal tone, and projecting your voice properly are all vital elements of managing your delivery during a speech.

4. Building positive engagement and mutual connection with your audience is essential for establishing good rapport early in your presentation.

5. Visual materials such as slides, handouts, and diagrams used to illustrate key concepts during a speech are called visual aids.

Part B: Matching Presentation Terms

VOCABULARY PRACTICE | WORKSHEET 21

1. D Preparation
2. A Rapport
3. B Body language
4. C Visual aids
5. E Q&A session

- **A.** A harmonious, trusting relationship established between speaker and listeners
- **B.** Postures, gestures, and physical movements used while speaking
- **C.** Charts, slides, and diagrams used to clarify information visually
- **D.** The structured process of planning, drafting, and organizing your speech
- **E.** The concluding segment dedicated to answering listener inquiries

Part C: Short Answer Exercises

1. What are the key dos and don'ts when preparing the introduction of a presentation?
Do welcome the audience, state the purpose and outline the presentation.
Don't start with irrelevant details, lengthy apologies or an unclear opening.
_____

2. How should a speaker handle difficult or hostile questions during the final question-and-answer period?
Remain calm and respectful, listen fully, clarify the question,
answer with facts and admit when you need to check something.
_____

Part A: Fill in the Blanks

Complete the sentences using terms from Units 62 and 63.

1. A negotiation where two parties try to reach an agreement over a contract or dispute is heavily influenced by the initial stage of negotiation.

2. Before entering formal talks, experienced negotiators spend significant time preparing their strategy, identifying their objectives and acceptable bargaining points.

3. The bargaining stage involves making concessions and counter-proposals to move the discussion closer to a mutually acceptable agreement.

4. Different negotiators exhibit different negotiating styles, ranging from cooperative and collaborative to highly confrontational and hard bargaining.

5. When preparing for a complex international deal, understanding cultural nuances is just as critical as analyzing the financial terms of the deal.

Part B: Matching Negotiation Terms

1. C Bargaining
2. D Concession
3. A Counter-proposal
4. E Negotiating style
5. B Deal

- **A.** A responding offer made in reaction to an initial bargaining position
- **B.** An agreement or contract reached after successful discussions
- **C.** The active discussion process of trading concessions to reach agreement
- **D.** Something given up voluntarily by one party to encourage agreement
- **E.** The characteristic approach or behavioral pattern adopted by a negotiator

Part C: Error Correction

Correct the italicized phrases:

1. "During the bargaining phase, we refused to make any concessions and immediately signed the contract." →
During the bargaining phase, we exchanged concessions before agreeing on and signing the contract.

2. "His negotiating style was entirely cooperative, meaning he shouted down every proposal made by the other side." →
His negotiating style was entirely confrontational: he shouted down every proposal made by the other side.

INBATHAMIZHAN K

PERSONALISED WORKSHEET APPLICATIONS | PART 1 OF 2

Vocabulary in My Own Words

The worksheet answers in the following section are retained. These additional examples connect the common units to my own interests, using different sentences instead of repeating a generic model response.

01. Jobs, CVs, references and recruitment

I would practise this language when planning and presenting the BHOOMI-X mapping/data project.

02. Employment terms, salaries and benefits

These words connect business communication with my goal of working in data engineering and cloud systems.

03. Offices, equality and occupational safety

I can practise a short example based on the BHOOMI-X mapping/data project, then revise it for clarity.

04. Management roles, entrepreneurs and company culture

The unit gives me a clearer way to communicate progress, problems and next steps in data engineering and cloud systems.

05. Business sectors, public companies and product launches

This vocabulary would help me discuss the BHOOMI-X mapping/data project while working with classmates.

06. Production, patents and research

I could use these expressions to describe professional responsibilities related to data engineering and cloud systems.

07. Service quality, benchmarking and market competition

When explaining programming, databases and cloud development, I can replace vague phrases with accurate terms from this unit.

08. Marketing, brands and market research

I would practise this language when planning and presenting the BHOOMI-X mapping/data project.

09. Retailing, franchising and consumers

These words connect business communication with my goal of working in data engineering and cloud systems.

10. Meetings, reports and presentations

I can practise a short example based on the BHOOMI-X mapping/data project, then revise it for clarity.

11. Sales communication and product launches

The unit gives me a clearer way to communicate progress, problems and next steps in data engineering and cloud systems.

Using the vocabulary professionally

I can group these terms by purpose - recruitment, workplace operations, business decisions and communication - then choose the words that fit the situation. Clear context matters more than using complex vocabulary.

INBATHAMIZHAN K

PERSONALISED WORKSHEET APPLICATIONS | PART 2 OF 2

Vocabulary in My Own Words

The worksheet answers in the following section are retained. These additional examples connect the common units to my own interests, using different sentences instead of repeating a generic model response.

12. Commercial law, contracts and disputes

This vocabulary would help me discuss the BHOOMI-X mapping/data project while working with classmates.

13. Shares, investment and stock markets

I could use these expressions to describe professional responsibilities related to data engineering and cloud systems.

14. The economy, inflation and economic indicators

When explaining programming, databases and cloud development, I can replace vague phrases with accurate terms from this unit.

15. Finance language and banking controls

I would practise this language when planning and presenting the BHOOMI-X mapping/data project.

16. Projects, budgets and deadlines

These words connect business communication with my goal of working in data engineering and cloud systems.

17. Leadership styles and workplace culture

I can practise a short example based on the BHOOMI-X mapping/data project, then revise it for clarity.

18. Business etiquette and telephone use

The unit gives me a clearer way to communicate progress, problems and next steps in data engineering and cloud systems.

19. Names, schedules and professional manners

This vocabulary would help me discuss the BHOOMI-X mapping/data project while working with classmates.

20. Meeting procedures, agendas and minutes

I could use these expressions to describe professional responsibilities related to data engineering and cloud systems.

21. Negotiating, compromise and consensus

When explaining programming, databases and cloud development, I can replace vague phrases with accurate terms from this unit.

22. Public speaking, presentation skills and bargaining

I would practise this language when planning and presenting the BHOOMI-X mapping/data project.

Using the vocabulary professionally

In a meeting or presentation, I can choose precise terms, explain them in context and avoid using business vocabulary where a simpler word is clearer. This helps the audience focus on the message.

INBATHAMIZHAN K

VOCABULARY WORKSHEETS | ONE-PAGE LEARNING SUMMARY

Professional and workplace vocabulary

I learned useful terms for jobs, recruitment, working arrangements and workplace responsibilities. This helps me understand formal communication in an office.

Word meanings and matching

Matching words with definitions helped me recognise the meaning of unfamiliar terms and choose vocabulary that fits the context.

Grammar and sentence correction

Correcting sentences helped me pay attention to prepositions, verb forms and clear sentence structure. I can use these skills in writing and speaking.

Business and employment concepts

The exercises introduced ideas such as salaries, wages, employee benefits and workplace policies, helping me understand professional situations.

Applying words in context

Fill-in-the-blanks and short-answer activities encouraged me to think about the meaning of each sentence instead of memorising answers.

My next steps

I will revise unfamiliar words, practise using them in original sentences and apply them in interviews, presentations, emails and everyday conversations.

Applying this learning

I can use workplace vocabulary in a CV, email or interview; use matching practice to check meaning; then write an original sentence before using a new term in conversation.

A simple revision routine

Select five unfamiliar terms, write a plain-language meaning, make one sentence connected to a real situation and revisit them later. This creates a practical link between recognising a word and using it confidently.

Overall reflection: Better vocabulary, clearer English and greater professional confidence.